Low-rank Grothendieck rings:

an AI-assisted classification project, constructions, and open problems

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Abstract

We present a public AI-generated research project on fusion rings and their categorifications over $\mathbb{C}$, with data extending through rank twelve. The project reports unrestricted Grothendieck-ring classifications in ranks two, three, and four, a complete multiplicity-free classification through rank twelve, and classifications or partial classifications at higher multiplicities. The released census contains 1,434,042 rings in ranks three through twelve; six categorification questions remain open within its stated bounds. The resources include research manuscripts, categorical models, exclusion arguments, verification code, and an interactive atlas. One categorical model per ring suffices for our classification problem; classifying all realizing categories up to equivalence is a further task. We summarize the current scope, compare it with AnyonWiki, and link to the online constructions catalogue and unresolved cases. The project's original research content was generated by AI under human direction; independent human verification remains pending.

1 The classification question and the current scope

For a fusion category $\mathcal{C}$ over $\mathbb{C}$, write $b_0 = 1, b_1, \dots, b_{r-1}$ for its simple-object classes. Its Grothendieck ring has multiplication and maximum fusion multiplicity

$$b_i b_j = \sum_{k=0}^{r-1} N_{ij}^k b_k, \qquad N_{ij}^k \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}, \qquad M(R) = \max_{i,j,k} N_{ij}^k.$$

The rank is r, and multiplicity-free means $M(R) = 1$. We count fusion rings up to based-ring isomorphism. All duality types are included, and commutativity is not assumed. The census enumerates fusion rings without filtering for categorifiability. The companion classification asks which of these rings are $K_0(\mathcal{C})$ for at least one complex fusion category.

The rank-one ring is $K_0(\mathrm{Vec})$. In rank two the family is $X^2 = 1 + nX$, $n \geq 0$, and only $n = 0, 1$ are categorifiable [1]. Both have $M = 1$, since the maximum includes the unit coefficients. The higher-rank scope is summarized in Table 1.

The released census contains 1,434,042 based-isomorphism classes in ranks three through twelve: 1,433,506 recorded general exclusions, 530 realizations, and six unresolved cases. The project reports a complete Grothendieck-ring classification at multiplicity one through rank twelve.

The rank-twelve band contains 632 rings: 480 general exclusions and 152 realizations. Of the realized rings, 151 have known unitary models; `R12_1_623` has a pseudo-unitary realization whose unitarity is unproved. This is an open question about unitarity, while its general complex categorifiability is decided.

At higher multiplicities, classification is complete within the displayed ranges wherever the unresolved count is zero. The complete contiguous ranges at ranks six, eight, and nine end at $M = 3, 2, 1$, respectively. There remain two open rings at rank six (one at each of $M = 4, 8$), three at rank eight ($M = 3$), and one at rank nine ($M = 2$).

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Rank	Census bound	Census rings	Excluded	Realized	Unresolved
2	all $n \geq 0$	symbolic	$n \geq 2$	2	0
3	$M \leq 1{,}000$	460,353	460,348	5	0
4	$M \leq 128$	889,530	889,515	15	0
5	$M \leq 20$	40,999	40,982	17	0
6	$M \leq 9$	25,421	25,362	57	2
7	$M \leq 5$	10,006	9,976	30	0
8	$M \leq 3$	4,500	4,404	93	3
9	$M \leq 2$	2,225	2,148	76	1
10	$M = 1$	194	136	58	0
11	$M = 1$	182	155	27	0
12	$M = 1$	632	480	152	0

Table 1: Reported project status checked on 29 October 2026. Counts concern the displayed census ranges; they are based-ring counts, not numbers of tensor-equivalence classes. The project reports **unrestricted classification in ranks two, three, and four**; their finite census bounds are not hypotheses of those claims. All project claims remain subject to independent human verification.

Here "realized" means that a categorical model is recorded, "excluded" means that a general obstruction is recorded, and "complete" means that every ring in the stated census range has one of these two decisions. These labels describe the project's reported mathematical conclusions. Neither a surviving necessary condition nor a failed construction attempt decides categorifiability.

2 Mathematical methods and verification

The project combines structural arguments with exact finite calculations. Its criteria include arithmetic and cyclotomic restrictions, formal codegrees, induction to the Drinfeld center, Frobenius–Schur indicators, fusion subcategories, module categories, and coherence obstructions. A positive decision requires a categorical construction together with an identification of its full fusion tensor with the census representative. An exclusion must apply to every possible complex categorification; an obstruction restricted to pivotal, spherical, pseudo-unitary, unitary, or braided categories retains that restriction.

For `R8_3_1768`, pivotal duality implies that $X \otimes V \otimes X^*$ inherits the symmetry sign of a selfduality on V. Selfdual constituents of opposite second-indicator sign must therefore occur evenly. Its fusion tensor violates this parity for the forced indicator values, excluding the ring. The general-complex conclusion uses the established sphericalization and Galois existence reduction; six exact separation certificates verify the required necessary center domains. The unified frontier proofs record these dependencies and the stronger restrictions on the six open cases. No additional model is claimed.

For example, the unrestricted rank-four manuscript reports exactly fifteen Grothendieck rings, automatic sphericality of every categorification, and the sharp bounds

$$\mathrm{FPdim}(\mathcal{C}) \leq 24 + 12\sqrt{3}, \qquad M(K_0(\mathcal{C})) \leq 6.$$

Its argument reduces the problem theoretically to $\mathrm{FPdim}(\mathcal{C}) < 1000$ and $M \leq 31$, then applies exact checks to 1,692 remaining rings. The pivotal classification of Dong–Palcoux–Plessis [2] is a separate result with its stated hypothesis. In higher ranks the project treats general complex categorification, not only unitary models: the rank-six list includes a reported spherical realization whose ring admits no pseudo-unitary categorification.

Within the reported classification through rank twelve, the simple-ring audit finds exactly sixteen nontrivial simple multiplicity-free Grothendieck rings: $\mathbb{Z}[C_p]$ for primes $p \leq 12$, and $K_0(\mathrm{PSU}(2)_{2r-1})$ for $2 \leq r \leq 12$. Here simplicity means the absence of a proper nontrivial fusion subring, and $\mathrm{PSU}(2)_k$ is the even-label fusion subcategory of $\mathrm{SU}(2)_k$. This extends the rank-six pattern in [3, Corollary 5.9]; an analogous question in arbitrary rank was posed in [3, Question 5.10].

Three verification tasks must be distinguished: checking a released fusion tensor, checking a categorical argument or certificate, and proving that enumeration has missed no ring. For the recent rank-seven $M = 5$, rank-eight $M = 3$, rank-nine $M \leq 2$, and rank-ten through rank-twelve $M = 1$ releases, enumeration completeness relies on the supplied programs and producer completion records; the full searches were not independently rerun. Exact tensor-validity and based-isomorphism checks have a narrower scope. The verification guide and rank-twelve proof archive record the executed checks and their mathematical dependencies.

The same records identify external computations not rerun. Automated checks, separate AI reviews, and source checksums do not replace independent human verification of categorical arguments or enumeration completeness.

3 Comparison with AnyonWiki

Our fusion-ring census strictly extends the rank–multiplicity ranges reported in AnyonWiki [4, Table 1], including multiplicity-free rings through rank twelve and larger ranges at higher multiplicities. Our census is entirely AI-generated under human direction, with independent human verification pending; AnyonWiki's mathematical data were produced using software developed without AI assistance [4]. The categorification objectives also differ: for our Grothendieck-ring classification, one categorical model per ring suffices, whereas AnyonWiki provides a census of multiplicity-free pivotal fusion categories through rank seven up to equivalence, including compatible pivotal and braided structures [5].[1] Our Grothendieck-ring analysis also treats higher multiplicities.

AnyonWiki's ring enumeration also includes higher multiplicities [4, 6]. Our categorification work uses established human mathematics and, for some positive cases, explicit AnyonWiki data; the source and exact-comparison records document those inputs.

4 Constructions and unresolved cases online

The constructions catalogue records specific realizations not, to our knowledge, explicitly described in the literature, together with their known ingredients and the project's checks of the required hypotheses and fusion rules. These proposed realizations await independent verification; *new* is used only in this limited sense, without claiming novelty up to tensor equivalence or exoticness.

The six open rings are `R6_4_155`, `R6_8_1660`, `R8_3_928`, `R8_3_941`, `R8_3_1154`, and `R9_2_137`. The unresolved-cases page gives their exact tensors, invariants, proof references, and status under each categorical hypothesis.

The model catalogue and case directory include rank twelve in the same responsive interface, with filters for ring properties. The theory and definitions page explains these properties and the categorical structures under consideration. Individual records distinguish obstructions from implications between structures, and statements about a category itself from statements about a Galois conjugate. The live catalogues may evolve; the counts in this announcement refer to the dated status below.

[1] We retain the term "census" and the pivotal qualification used in [5], whose authors discuss correctness, completeness, and equivalence explicitly.

5 Resources, provenance, and independent review

The project has three complementary public entry points:

Resource	Contents
Fusion Ring Census	Enumeration programs, canonical fusion tensors, count tables, and census manuscripts.
Grothendieck Ring Classification	Classification manuscripts, models, exclusions, decision records, and exact replay materials.
Interactive atlas	Unified ring exploration, constructions and case records, unresolved questions, definitions, manuscripts, and source evidence.

The manuscript index identifies the current mathematical accounts, and the research-status page explains their verification scope. The two repositories and the atlas are also listed in references [7, 8, 9].

Sources and status. The counts are dated 29 October 2026. The immutable source baselines are classification commit `d920cc2531d8` and census commit `27d0c66fbcec`; the unified frontier revision supplies the new exclusion. The publication manifest and all-rank decision table record the current scope. Rank-specific manifests retain the exact census inputs used for each argument.

AI provenance. The project's original mathematical arguments, research exposition, enumeration and verification code, and computational outputs were generated by AI under the contributor's direction. This announcement was likewise prepared with ChatGPT. Cited theorems, known categories, and imported data retain their external authorship. Independent human verification and Lean formalization of the project remain pending.

Independent review is invited of the classification reductions, the scope of the exact certificates, categorical constructions and their coherence, and comparisons with the existing literature. Resolving a listed open case requires either a categorical model or an obstruction covering all possible categorifications.

References

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